

Yuanyuan Gao

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EDUCATION

University of Zurich and Swiss Finance Institute Ph.D. in Finance Advisors: Per Östberg and Steven Ongena	2021 – 2027 (expected)
University of Zurich M.A. in Banking and Finance, minor in Quantitative Finance	2018 – 2020
Chongqing University B.Eng. in Civil Engineering	2013 – 2017

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Financial Intermediation, Banking, Information in Credit Markets
Secondary: Corporate Finance, Empirical Credit Markets

JOB MARKET PAPER

Beyond the Closing Bank: The Indirect Effect of Branch Closures on Firms (with Lorenzo Ferrante)

When a bank closes its local branch, what happens to the firm's other lenders? Using Italian credit-register data (AnaCredit) matched to the branch register, we follow about 18,000 cases in which a firm's local bank closes its branch and decompose their lost credit by lender. The closing bank accounts for only about a third of the decline. The firm's other incumbent lenders, banks that closed nothing, also cut credit and account for roughly 70% of the total. Rather than substituting for the departing local bank, co-lenders act as complements. We document two channels. In an information channel, co-lenders' default forecasts for affected firms become less accurate, and they cut more when they can observe the closing bank's actions through the credit register. In a firm channel, affected firms become riskier, and co-lenders cut more when the firm depended more on the closing bank. The cost of losing a local bank thus spreads through the firm's whole lending network.

WORKING PAPERS

Impeded Flights in European Sovereign Debt Markets (with Lorenzo Ferrante, Per Östberg and Thomas Richter)

Theory predicts that yield shocks trigger flights from risky to safe assets. In the European sovereign bond market, these flights are impeded: after stress events, trading volume falls by 30% over the following week rather than increasing. The mechanism is a collapse in liquidity supply: bid-ask spreads rise by 56% and market depth falls sharply. Exploiting that the same bond trades on both a domestic and a pan-European MTS platform, we show that spreads widen more, depth falls more and volume drops more on the domestic platform, where market makers hold more of their own sovereign's debt. Bank-dealers' concentrated exposure to sovereign risk can freeze a central secondary market when rebalancing is most needed.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Bank Competition and Information Production

How local lending competition shapes banks' incentives to produce private information, measured with banks' internal default-probability assessments in the credit register.

PRESENTATIONS

2026

IBEFA Summer Meeting at the WEAI Annual Conference, Denver[†]; SFI Research Days; University of Zurich Brown Bag Seminar (also 2022, 2024)

2025

Annual Financial Markets and Liquidity Conference, Budapest; Rising Scholars in Finance Conference, Zurich (poster)[†]

Coauthor presentations

European Central Bank internal seminar (2026)

[†] also discussant

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Zurich

- Empirical Corporate Finance (Ph.D.), teaching assistant and exercise sessions, 2024 – present
Teaching evaluation: 6.0 / 6.0
- Seminar in Takeovers, Restructuring and Corporate Governance (M.A.), teaching assistant, 2020 – present
- Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses in empirical corporate finance and banking, about 7–9 per year

FELLOWSHIPS

Swiss Finance Institute PhD Scholarship

2021 – 2022

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, Python, R, $\LaTeX$

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent), German (B1)

REFERENCES

Prof. Per Östberg

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